Equal Shares

TEACHER KEY

1st Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Cut circles, rectangles and squares into halves and fourths, color the shares, and see why parts must be the same size. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Cut a circle into 2 equal shares. What is each share called?
   A half (one half)
2. How many fourths make a whole rectangle?
   4 fourths
3. Which is bigger: one half or one fourth of the same circle?
   One half
4. A rectangle is cut into 2 parts that are not the same size. Are they halves?
   No. Halves must be equal shares.

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Explore more

5. Color 2 fourths of a square. How much of the square is colored?

Two fourths, the same amount as one half

6. How many halves make one whole?

2 halves

Reflect

7. Reflect: Why does cutting into more equal shares make each share smaller?

The same whole is split among more parts, so each part gets less.

Teacher notes

- Use the Not equal parts button as a non-example: Are these halves? How do you know?
- Compare a half and a fourth of the same shape side by side; ask which you would rather have of a pizza.
- Students can tap shares or use Tab and Enter to color them.

Standards: 1.G.A.3. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool's picture.